Groupware Heuristics Evaluation

Session A is the baseline (Discord voice only); Session B uses Discord voice with our group bot.

Coding key

Present	The mechanism exists and worked during testing.
Constrained	Supported, but limited; users met difficulty or needed a workaround.
Absent	The task needed the mechanism, but the system did not provide it.
N/A	The test tasks did not trigger this situation, so it cannot be judged.

Evaluation

#	Heuristic	Session A Discord voice only	Session B With Pally	Evidence
1	**Provide the means for intentional and appropriate verbal communication**	**Present**	**Present**	Session A All three testers illustrate strong behavior of chatting and communication through discord voice channel. This allows them for synchronous communication. Session B There is a relatively decreasing trends in verbal communication while using the Pally, especially for my observation target.
2	**Provide the means for intentional and appropriate gesture communication**	N/A	N/A	Session A Since participants did not show their faces, gestures were unobservable in this session. Session B Similar result with session A.
3	**Provide consequential communication of an individual's embodiment**	Constrained	Present	Session A There's only limited observation of user's hesitation before talking, and thinking process while typing in discord chat. Session B Specifically, there are obvious and observable hesitations, thinking while tying and content adjusting before send for my target in observation session B.
4	**Provide consequential communication of shared artifacts**	N/A	Present	Session A Not fit in session A Session B According to the observation, no participant knows the exact person that actually triggers the bot

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				function, the only public output was the result selected by each participant anonymously, and generated by the bot.
5	**Provide protection**	N/A	Present	Session A Not fit in session A Session B Obviously, while no one knows who is actually triggering the bot function, the privacy of the user is under protection.
6	**Management of tightly and loosely-coupled collaboration**	Constrained	Present	Session A While the testing session is conducted remotely and synchronously, asynchronous communications are limited during the verbal chatting. Session B While using the pally, its functionalities contain both asynchronous and synchronous coordination between players. The former is the excuse generator and random selector, allows for immediate result illustrating, while the latter is shown by the trait picker, enable participants to interact asynchronously within certain time frame, and summarize the result.
7	**Allow people to coordinate their actions**	Constrained	Present	Session A Limited coordination was observed between players during the verbal chatting session, they prefer to arguing and quarreling instead of negotiating. Session B Clearly, the argument and quarrel are decreased while the similar situation happens to the participants when using Pally, they trend to use extra tools to break the deadlock between them.
8	**Facilitate finding collaborators and establishing contacts**	N/A	Constrained	Session A Not suitable in session A Session B According to my observation, Pally has limit help in finding and facilitating connections with others, while the choices and results can be rejected by other players who are more dominant within the group.j

Key Observations
My observation target was chosen as the random pick, while his opinion was ignored by others previously. Interestingly, the conflict stops when he is selected, and his idea becomes the group decision.